PassFrame
TUITION

The Otter's Secret Pool

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Every morning, before the village had even rubbed the sleep from its eyes, Pip the otter slipped out of her burrow and down to the secret pool. The water there was so still that it looked like a sheet of green glass, and the willow trees leaned over it as if they were whispering secrets to one another.

Pip loved the pool because nobody else knew about it — not the ducks who quacked loudly by the millpond, not the herons who stood like grey statues at the river's edge, and certainly not Old Badger, who grumbled about everything.

One cold morning, Pip found something strange floating on the water: a little paper boat, folded so carefully that it must have taken someone hours to make. She nudged it gently with her nose, and it spun in a slow circle, as graceful as a dancer.

'Who could have made this?' Pip wondered. She searched the muddy bank for footprints but found none — only a single white feather resting on a stone.

Pip decided to leave the little boat exactly where she had found it. Whoever had made it might come back, and she wanted them to know that the secret pool kept its visitors' secrets too.

That evening, as the sun sank behind the hills, Pip noticed the paper boat had gone. In its place lay a tiny acorn, polished until it shone like gold.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. Where did Pip go every morning before the village woke up?

2. What did Pip find floating on the pool one cold morning?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you Pip liked the pool because it was private.

4. Underline 3 similes in the extract.

5. What does “nudged” mean as it is used in the extract?

6. True or false: Old Badger grumbled about everything.

7. Why do you think Pip decided to leave the paper boat exactly where she found it?

8. What was left on the bank instead of footprints?

9. In your own words, describe what the secret pool looked like.

10. What do you think the white feather might tell us about who made the boat?

11. What did Pip find in place of the paper boat that evening?

12. Do you think Pip made the right choice by leaving the boat alone? Explain your answer.